

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1 Method, Approach and the Methodological Turn

2 Empirical and Normative Inquiry by Content

3 Traditional Approaches and Their Thinkers

4 Illustrations, Comparison and Trap Repair

5 Boundaries, Revision and Source Discipline

6 Behaviouralism's Eight Tenets

7 Post-Behavioural Relevance and Action

8 Easton and Almond: Systems and Structural Functions

9 Deutsch, Decision-Making, Marxian Analysis and Model Comparison

10 Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g2 **PYQ ownership:** No directly owned verified PYQ is assigned to this topic; all questions below are original practice.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Method**?

A. The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained. B. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values. C. those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour. D. understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Method** with **The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.**

A. Integration B. Method C. Marxian approach D. Empirical statement

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.** with **Method.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Approach**?

A. Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions. B. rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data. C. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data. D. political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Approach** with **A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.**

A. David Easton - systems analysis B. Leo Strauss C. Normative statement D. Approach

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.** with **Approach.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Empirical statement**?

A. A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation. B. Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification. C. precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it. D. the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Empirical statement** with **A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation**.

A. Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach B. Empirical statement C. David Easton D. Behaviouralism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation** with **Empirical statement**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Normative statement**?

A. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction. B. an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference). C. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed. D. every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Normative statement** with **A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed**.

A. Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach B. Method C. Post-behaviouralism D. Normative statement

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed** with **Normative statement**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Behaviouralism**?

A. A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups. B. political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories. C. research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory. D. government functions like a steering

mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Behaviouralism** with **A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.**

A. Decision-making approach B. Behaviouralism C. Approach D. Traditional

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.** with **Behaviouralism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Post-behaviouralism**?

A. those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour. B. understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems. C. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values. D. political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Post-behaviouralism** with **A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.**

A. Marxian approach B. Empirical statement C. Behavioural D. Post-behaviouralism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.** with **Post-behaviouralism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Traditional**?

A. Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions. B. rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data. C. political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences. D. politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Traditional** with **Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different

pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.**

A. Leo Strauss B. Traditional C. Normative statement D. Post-behavioural

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.** with **Traditional**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Behavioural**?

A. precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it. B. the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports. C. Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification. D. Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Behavioural** with **Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.**

A. David Easton B. Behaviouralism C. Regularities D. Behavioural

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.** with **Behavioural**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Post-behavioural**?

A. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction. B. an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference). C. every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another). D. Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Post-behavioural** with **Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.**

A. Method B. Post-behavioural C. Post-behaviouralism D. Verification

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.** with **Post-behavioural**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Regularities**?

A. research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory. B. government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals. C. political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories. D. The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Regularities** with **political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.**

A. Approach B. Traditional C. Techniques D. Regularities

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.** with **Regularities**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Verification**?

A. those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour. B. understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems. C. political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice. D. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Verification** with **those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.**

A. Empirical statement B. Verification C. Behavioural D. Quantification

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.** with **Verification**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Techniques**?

A. political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences. B. politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class. C. rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data. D. A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Techniques** with **rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.**

A. Normative statement B. Post-behavioural C. Values D. Techniques

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.** with **Techniques**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Quantification**?

A. precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it. B. the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports. C. Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality. D. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Quantification** with **precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.**

A. Behaviouralism B. Quantification C. Regularities D. Systematization

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.** with **Quantification**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Values**?

A. every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another). B. Gives both the

behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action. C. an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference). D. A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Values** with **an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference)**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference)**.

A. Post-behaviouralism B. Verification C. Pure science D. Values

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference)**. with **Values**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Systematization**?

A. research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory. B. government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals. C. The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained. D. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Systematization** with **research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory**.

A. Traditional B. Systematization C. Techniques D. Integration

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory**. with **Systematization**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Pure science**?

A. political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice. B. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data. C. understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems. D. Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Pure science** with **understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.**

A. Behavioural B. Quantification C. David Easton - systems analysis D. Pure science

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.** with **Pure science.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Integration**?

A. political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences. B. politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class. C. A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation. D. Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Integration** with **political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.**

A. Post-behavioural B. Integration C. Values D. Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.** with **Integration.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **David Easton - systems analysis**?

A. Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality. B. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed. C. the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports. D. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **David Easton - systems analysis** with **the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports.** The other options

are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports.**

A. Regularities B. Systematization C. Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach D. David Easton - systems analysis

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports.** with **David Easton - systems analysis**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach**?

A. every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another). B. Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action. C. A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups. D. political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach** with **every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).**

A. Verification B. Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach C. Pure science D. Decision-making approach

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).** with **Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach**?

A. The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained. B. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values. C. government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals. D. those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach** with **government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals.**

A. Techniques B. Integration C. Marxian approach D. Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals.** with **Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Decision-making approach**?

A. political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice. B. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data. C. Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions. D. rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Decision-making approach** with **political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.**

A. Quantification B. Decision-making approach C. David Easton - systems analysis D. Leo Strauss

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.** with **Decision-making approach.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Marxian approach**?

A. A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation. B. Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification. C. politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class. D. precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marxian approach** with **politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class.**

A. Values B. Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach C. David Easton D. Marxian approach

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class.** with **Marxian approach.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Leo Strauss**?

A. Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality. B. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed. C. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction. D. an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Leo Strauss** with **Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.**

A. Systematization B. Leo Strauss C. Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach D. Method

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.** with **Leo Strauss**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **David Easton**?

A. A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups. B. political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories. C. Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action. D. research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **David Easton** with **Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.**

A. Pure science B. Decision-making approach C. Approach D. David Easton

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.** with **David Easton**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ STATUS

No directly owned verified UPSC PYQ is assigned to this Political Theory topic. Political Theory is a conceptual-support repository, and the source mapping expressly prohibits proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ routing. The questions below are therefore labelled as original practice, not PYQs.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish method from approach in political inquiry and explain why the distinction matters. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Method and approach both organise inquiry, but they operate at different levels.

Core analysis: A method is a procedure for obtaining, testing and interpreting knowledge, such as observation, comparison, historical reconstruction or statistical analysis. An approach is wider: it includes methods but also criteria for selecting the problem, relevant actors, admissible data and explanatory variables. A behavioural approach, for example, directs attention toward observable conduct and may then use surveys or quantification as methods. A philosophical approach selects conceptual coherence and normative justification as central problems and uses argument as a method. Vernon Van Dyke's distinction therefore prevents tools from being confused with intellectual frames.

Critical evaluation: Methods are not neutral instruments floating outside an approach, because the choice of data already reflects a view of what matters. Yet the distinction remains analytically useful: approaches set the agenda, while methods make investigation disciplined and publicly testable.

Conclusion: The distinction matters because method governs the reliability of inquiry, whereas approach also governs its intellectual agenda by deciding which problems, actors and evidence become visible.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why must empirical and normative statements be classified by content rather than grammatical form? Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Empirical and normative statements differ by the kind of claim they make, not simply by whether their wording contains 'is' or 'ought'.

Core analysis: An empirical statement describes an observable relation that can be checked through evidence, repetition or consequences. A normative statement expresses a value, obligation or preferred order and requires moral justification. Gauba's examples expose the grammatical trap. 'Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work' can be empirical in content because the proposed condition may be tested against democratic functioning. A definition such as 'justice is treating equals equally' may use 'is' while still expressing a normative standard. Instrumental prescriptions can therefore be empirical, and descriptive-looking definitions can be evaluative.

Critical evaluation: Evidence cannot by itself prove an ultimate moral end, while moral language cannot shield a factual claim from testing. Correct classification requires asking whether the claim is verifiable, evaluative or a combination requiring both forms of reasoning.

Conclusion: Political analysis must test what kind of claim is being made rather than searching mechanically for 'is' or 'ought', because factual conditions can be phrased prescriptively and value judgments descriptively.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Examine behaviouralism's eight tenets and its contribution to political science. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Behaviouralism reoriented political science toward the systematic study of actual political behaviour rather than exclusive reliance on formal institutions or inherited texts.

Core analysis: Its commonly taught Eastonian tenets are regularities, verification, techniques, quantification, value separation, systematization, pure science and integration. Regularities make generalisation possible; verification tests claims against observation; techniques and quantification improve precision; value separation distinguishes empirical explanation from ethical judgment; systematization connects theory and research; pure science gives explanation logical priority over application; and integration opens political science to other social sciences. Wallas, Bentley, Merriam and Lasswell prepared this movement by studying psychology, groups, power and policy.

Further development: The tenets are mutually supporting rather than a checklist of isolated slogans. Regularities require verification; verification depends on suitable techniques; quantification is justified only where measurement preserves meaning; and systematization prevents data collection from becoming theory-free. Integration supplies concepts and methods from neighbouring disciplines, while pure science marks an ordering of inquiry rather than a permanent ban on application. The strongest assessment therefore distinguishes behaviouralism's scientific discipline from scientism, the mistaken belief that only measurable questions are politically significant.

Critical evaluation: The contribution was substantial: political inquiry gained clearer hypotheses, comparative data and methodological self-criticism. Its limits were method-fetish, excessive micro-focus and distance from urgent injustice. Scientific rigour enlarged political knowledge, but could not decide which questions deserved priority.

Conclusion: Behaviouralism made political inquiry more systematic, verifiable and interdisciplinary, but its scientific contribution remains defensible only when technique serves significant political questions rather than replacing them.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate post-behaviouralism as a correction of, rather than a rejection of, behaviouralism. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Post-behaviouralism arose from dissatisfaction with behavioural political science's retreat into tractable method while public crises demanded responsible knowledge.

Core analysis: Easton's correction preserved behaviouralism's achievements-regularities, verification, rigorous technique and empirical explanation-but added relevance and action. Relevance requires research to address significant problems such as war, poverty, discrimination and injustice instead of selecting questions only because they are easily measured. Action requires scholars to accept responsibility for applying knowledge toward social betterment. The movement also made value choice explicit: deciding what to study and whom research serves cannot be treated as politically innocent.

Further development: Its correction also changes the scholar's role. Behavioural detachment protects research from propaganda, but detachment cannot mean indifference to how knowledge is selected or used. Relevance identifies important public problems, action connects findings to possible remedies, and value-consciousness requires explicit justification of ends. The residual danger is that urgency may reward weak evidence or ideological certainty. Post-behaviouralism succeeds only when public responsibility is joined to reproducible inquiry and critical scrutiny.

Critical evaluation: This is not permission for unsupported activism. Evidence standards remain necessary, and a fashionable cause does not validate weak analysis. Post-behaviouralism corrects the purpose and public orientation of science; it does not replace verification with conviction. Its durable position is therefore a synthesis of rigour, relevance and accountable action.

Conclusion: Post-behaviouralism is best understood as value-conscious science: it retains verification and technique while restoring relevance, action and public responsibility.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Compare the systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian models of political analysis. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: The five models organise political explanation around different units and mechanisms, so comparison must ask what each reveals and conceals.

Core analysis: Easton's systems analysis traces demands and supports through conversion into outputs and feedback, explaining persistence and adaptation. Almond's structural-functional model compares the universal functions performed by different formal or informal structures. Deutsch's communications model treats government as a steering process dependent on information flow, load, lag and corrective feedback. Decision-making analysis reconstructs who chose among which alternatives under particular informational, value and organisational constraints. Marxian analysis locates institutions and ideas within the economic base, class relations and dominant interests.

Further development: Model choice should follow the explanatory problem. A demand moving through institutions is suited to Easton's input-output-feedback cycle; comparison across unlike formal structures is suited to Almond's functional grid; bureaucratic learning is illuminated by Deutsch's information flows; a discrete policy choice requires decision-process reconstruction; and concealed ownership power calls for Marxian analysis. Objections also differ: systems and functionalism are criticised for stability bias, communications for underplaying conflict, decision-making for ignoring pre-structured alternatives, and Marxism for economic reductionism. Triangulating models can test whether one model's omitted variable changes the conclusion, but models cannot simply be stacked without a clear causal sequence.

Critical evaluation: Systems and functional models can privilege equilibrium; communications language can mechanise politics; decision analysis may become elite-centred and episodic; Marxian analysis may reduce political autonomy to economics. Their strengths are therefore conditional, not cumulative proof of one master model.

Conclusion: The five models should be treated as complementary but limited lenses: each identifies a different causal mechanism, and no one model can explain stability, function, information, choice and class power simultaneously.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Can political science be value-free? Discuss with reference to behaviouralism, Strauss and post-behaviouralism. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: The ideal of value-free political science seeks to protect factual explanation from the researcher's moral preferences, but it cannot remove values from every stage of inquiry.

Core analysis: Behaviouralism usefully separates empirical propositions from ethical evaluation and demands verification, regularity and disciplined technique. This prevents desired conclusions from substituting for evidence. Strauss objects that political inquiry cannot understand tyranny, justice or the good regime while refusing to judge values; selection of politically important problems already presupposes standards of significance. Post-behaviouralism converts that criticism into methodological reform: research must retain scientific rigour while becoming relevant, action-oriented and conscious of its public consequences.

Further development: The empirical-normative distinction should be preserved even when complete neutrality is rejected. Whether turnout changed, an institution complied with a rule or an attitude correlates with behaviour remains an evidential question. Whether participation is adequate, compliance legitimate or an attitude unjust requires evaluative reasons. Strauss protects the latter inquiry; behaviouralism disciplines the former; post-behaviouralism asks how the two can address public problems together. The remaining danger is ideological capture, where relevance becomes an excuse to predetermine findings. Transparent question selection, replicable evidence, explicit value premises and openness to criticism provide a stronger settlement than either scientific withdrawal or untested activism.

Critical evaluation: The distinction between detachment and ethical neutrality is decisive. Scholars should disclose premises, test factual claims and avoid partisan distortion, yet they must still justify why particular ends, harms and exclusions matter. Value control is possible; complete value absence is not.

Conclusion: Political science can discipline factual inquiry against partisan assertion, but it cannot become value-free in its choice of problems, interpretation of significance or judgment of political ends.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.